



The Grand Chronicle

Sid Meier's Civilization VI

Complete Edition · Final build 1.0.12.68 (July 2024)

26 mods · Installation · How to Play · Six Personas

Compiled August 2026 — for the last version of the game

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1 Installation

Everything you need to go from a vanilla install to *The Grand Chronicle*, with the right mod manager and a load order that stays stable.

1.1 What you need

- *The Complete Edition of Civ VI on Steam* — base game, **Rise and Fall**, **Gathering Storm**, the **New Frontier Pass**, and the **Leader Pass**. Every mod in this list targets the Gathering Storm ruleset, and several assume the later content.
- *A current game build*. The final version of the game is *1.0.12.68* (last update: July 15, 2024; the content roadmap had ended earlier with the Leader Pass in March 2023). Steam updates automatically — you are current if there is no pending update and the Leader Pass leaders appear in-game.
- *15 GB of free disk space* for the Workshop downloads.
- *Steam subscribed* to nothing else required — the Workshop does the downloading.

Good to know

This list is designed for the **last** version of the game. Mods that were not updated for the final build (e.g. old monolithic UI packs such as CQUI) are deliberately excluded — every mod below is verified to exist and remain in active use on the Workshop.

1.2 The mod manager: how Civ 6 actually does it

Civ 6 has *no community-standard external mod manager* — unlike Skyrim or Stellaris there is no widely used third-party tool, and Vortex is actively discouraged by the community. Instead, the power-user setup has three layers:

1. *The Steam Workshop* — this is where every mod lives and where subscribing **is** the installation. Subscribe to the items in Chapter 2 (or save them into your own Workshop **Collection** to reinstall in one click).
2. *Enhanced Mod Manager* — a Workshop mod by FinalFreak16 (over a million subscribers) that replaces the clunky in-game mod screen: it splits your mods into **enabled** and **disabled** lists, adds filters, and shows each mod's description and dependencies at a glance.
3. *The in-game Additional Content screen* — the game's own mod list (from the main menu: **Additional Content** → **Mods**). This is where you toggle mods for each game.

Tip

Subscribing is enough — the game detects Workshop mods automatically. You only need the local Mods folder when a mod is not on the Workshop (none in this list are).

1.2.1 Where the files live

- *Workshop mods*: `Steam\steamapps\workshop\content\289070\<item id>\` — one folder per subscribed item.
- *Local mods*: `Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization VI\Mods\`

1.2.2 Load order: how conflicts are resolved

Civ 6 has *no drag-and-drop load order*. Each mod's `.modinfo` file declares a `<LoadOrder>` number: lower values load first, higher values load later and win conflicts.

LoadOrder	Intended phase
-100	Schema changes — data removal, core adjustments
-50	Premature updates — must run before content is added
0	Standard content — the default for most mods
50	Post-updates — applied after most content

For The Grand Chronicle this mostly takes care of itself: the mods in Chapter 2 are non-overlapping by design (one AI overhaul, cosmetic mods with known companions). If you **ever** need a mod to override another, edit that mod's .modinfo (raise its <LoadOrder>), keep a backup, and remember Steam will overwrite your edit on the next mod update.

1.3 Installation, step by step

1. *Install and launch the game once* (vanilla) to generate your settings and confirm the build works.
2. *Subscribe to the mods* — every Workshop item in Chapter 2, plus *Enhanced Mod Manager* (Workshop item 1601259406). Steam downloads them in the background.
3. *Verify the downloads* — the items appear in workshop\content\289070\ when complete.
4. *Launch the game* and open **Additional Content** → **Mods**. With Enhanced Mod Manager you now see two lists; move every subscribed item to the enabled list.
5. *Order check* — no action needed; the load order comes from the mods' own .modinfo values.
6. *Start a game* with the settings from Chapter 3 and play a few turns to confirm everything loads.
7. *Optional: build your Collection* — in the Workshop, add all 27 items to one collection so future reinstalls are one click.

Watch out

Do *not* stack the AI overhaul with other AI mods (AI+, RHAI, Better Balanced Game) — mixing them produces erratic AI behavior. Chapter 2 includes exactly one AI mod for this reason.

1.4 Troubleshooting

- *Crash on the leader screen / at game start* — Civ 6 has a hard-coded asset limit for animated leaders and high-detail assets. Disable the newest high-asset mods (or graphics mods) you added last, and re-test. In this list, the usual suspects are graphics mods if you add extra ones.
- *Mod shows as “incompatible”* — the game flags mods whose declared compatibility predates the current build. The mods in this list are verified to still load on 1.0.12.68; if one ever flags, check its Workshop page for an update before removing it.
- *Odd behavior after a Steam update* — Steam may overwrite .modinfo edits or a mod update changes things. Re-check the affected mod's notes.
- *Still broken?* — Verify game files (Steam → right-click Civ VI → Properties → Installed Files → Verify), then delete the Cache folder under Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization VI\ and relaunch. Disable mods one at a time to isolate the culprit.

2 The Modlist

Twenty-six verified mods in four categories. Every entry was checked against its live Steam Workshop page (author, item id, update date) at the time of writing. None of them make the game easier or hand you power — they make the AI think, the map beautiful, and your decisions informed.

2.1 1 • AI & Strategy

The single most important mod in the list. One AI overhaul only — the community consensus is that AI mods must not be stacked.

Real Strategy (AI)

by infixo

What it does: A different approach to making the AI better: a mixture of Lua 'thinking' and tuned AI lists. The AI plans districts and units coherently, pursues victory types, and handles war and naval play sensibly instead of drifting.

Why it's in the Chronicle: This is the 'more AI' request in one package — a smarter opponent that respects the game's own systems, which raises the challenge without cheating.

Compatibility: Do not combine with AI+, RHAI or Better Balanced Game. Updated August 2023 for the final build.

2.2 2 • Interface & Information

Thirteen UI mods that reveal information the vanilla interface hides. None change balance — they turn guessing into planning, which is exactly the kind of depth this list is about.

Quick Deals

by wltk

What it does: Shows every AI's offer for the items you want to trade in one sorted window (hotkey D), so you can sell to the highest bidder with one click.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Trade transparency: you see the market instead of blind-clicking leaders.

Compatibility: UI-only; works with everything.

Detailed Map Tacks

by wltk

What it does: Map tacks now compute and display the actual yields and adjacency bonuses a district or wonder would get at that spot — before you commit.

Why it's in the Chronicle: City planning becomes a real craft: you plan districts the way the game's systems reward.

Compatibility: UI-only; pairs with the Map Lens in More Lenses.

Extended Policy Cards

by Aristos

What it does: Shows the concrete effects of every policy card on your current empire (e.g. +3 Gold, +2 Culture) instead of vague prose.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Government choices stop being memorization — you see the trade-off your empire actually faces.

Compatibility: Requires Better Report Screen (below) to display the effects. Works with vanilla, R&F and GS.

Extended Diplomacy Ribbon

by Aristos

What it does: Adds an at-a-glance ribbon showing each leader's government, military strength, amenities, and current diplomatic stance toward you.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Diplomacy becomes readable: you know who is friendly, who is posturing, and who to bribe.

Compatibility: UI-only; works with vanilla, R&F and GS.

Better Report Screen (UI)

by infixo

What it does: Reworks the report screen with far more information and new tabs: units, deals, policies, and city-states.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Empire-wide bookkeeping — the backbone that Extended Policy Cards draws on.

Compatibility: Required by Extended Policy Cards. Safe with all official scenarios.

Better Civilopedia (UI)

by infixo

What it does: The Civilopedia now shows decoded modifiers, district adjacencies, and AI strategies — the actual numbers behind the prose.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The reference book becomes worth opening: you can learn how the systems really work.

Compatibility: UI-only; language-independent.

More Lenses

by astor

What it does: Adds lenses for settler placement (highlighting settleable spots), adjacency, appeal, and more to the map lens menu.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The map tells you what your empire could become, not just what it is.

Compatibility: UI-only. Already bundled inside CQUI/HBUI — we don't use those, so this is the standalone version.

Better Trade Screen

by astor

What it does: Trade routes become sortable and filterable by yield (food, production, gold, science, culture, faith) with multi-level sorting.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Managing a trade empire is a real strategic layer once you can see every route's value.

Compatibility: UI-only; do not combine with CQUI/HBUI.

Production Queue

by Lozenge

What it does: Adds production queues to cities: left-click appends, Ctrl-click or middle-click inserts at the top; drag to reorder.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Late-game city management without endless re-selecting — a quiet quality-of-life depth add.

Compatibility: UI-only; does not work in hotseat games.

Great Works Viewer

by Glindor

What it does: Improves the Great Works screen: sort by building type, expand to full screen, filter by work slot, and a theming helper.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The culture game becomes legible — you can actually plan theming bonuses.

Compatibility: UI-only.

Sukritact's Simple UI Adjustments

by sukritact

What it does: A set of small quality-of-life changes: worked tiles, next border growth and city yields on hover, easier citizen management, and more.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The 'details' layer — small conveniences that make reading your empire effortless.

Compatibility: UI-only; updated October 2024, the most recently maintained item in this category.

Sukritact's Global Relations Panel

by sukritact

What it does: One panel showing how every civilization feels about every other — opinions, agreements, and agendas at a glance.

Why it's in the Chronicle: You finally see the diplomatic web you are playing inside, not just your own inbox.

Compatibility: UI-only.

Better Combat Preview (UI)

by Maple_Leaves

What it does: Rich combat previews: current HP, strength differences, damage ranges, and likely results, with a detailed breakdown when many factors are at play.

Why it's in the Chronicle: War becomes calculation instead of gambling — you commit to fights you can read.

Compatibility: UI-only; does not cover air combats.

2.3 3 • Graphics & Immersion

Six visual mods that make the map calmer, richer, and easier to read. All cosmetic; none touch gameplay numbers.

Environment Skin: Sid Meier's Civilization V

by GrrrrArrrg

What it does: Re-textures terrain and shifts the color key toward Civ V's calmer, more muted palette, with more detailed terrain textures.

Why it's in the Chronicle: If Civ VI's saturated 'board-game' look wears on you, this is the classic one-stop visual modernizer.

Compatibility: Compatible with every release up to and including Gathering Storm; designed to work with Hillier Hills and Vegetation mods.

Hillier Hills

by Deliverator23

What it does: Changes the heightmap of hills so they are more prominent and visibly elevated — terrain reads better at a glance.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Readable terrain is strategy you can see: chokepoints and defensive hills jump out.

Compatibility: Compatible with Environment Skin and Denser Vegetation. Incompatible with Leugi's Colder Tundra (a combined version exists if you ever want it).

City Sprawl Graphics

by Hiraeth

What it does: Buildings now appear on the outskirts of districts placed adjacent to the city centre — your metropolises visually sprawl as they grow.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The 'living empire' feeling: growth you can see on the map.

Compatibility: Visual only; a heavier asset mod, so it is a candidate to disable first if you ever hit the leader-asset crash limit.

Denser Vegetation (for Civ V Skin)

by JNR

What it does: Dense, forest-like vegetation with terrain-tinted variants so you can still tell what lies underneath; entirely cosmetic.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Forests become forests — the map stops looking like a garden and starts looking like a continent.

Compatibility: Use this 'for Civ V Skin' version because we run Environment Skin (the standalone version targets the default skins). Enable the 'High-Detail Clutter' graphics option for full effect.

Colorized Historic Moments

by MiniRagnarok

What it does: Replaces the historic-moment art with colorized artwork — over 250 moments colorized.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Your empire's history book gets the detail it deserves; can be enabled/disabled without touching saves.

Compatibility: Visual only.

Prettier Lakes

by pokiehl

What it does: Enhances the flat water textures of lakes, oases, and several natural wonders (Dead Sea, Crater Lake, Lake Victoria, and more).

Why it's in the Chronicle: Small water detail that noticeably improves map photography.

Compatibility: Visual only; includes a variant texture for Terra Mirabilis's Lake Victoria.

2.4 4 • World & Content

Six mods that add detail, depth, and things to discover — new wonders, new resources, new terrain, dynamic names, and the map pack. All are additions, not power spikes.

Terra Mirabilis

by Deliverator & ChimpanG

What it does: Reworks the natural wonders and adds 20 new ones, including fan favourites: Victoria Falls, Rock of Gibraltar, Krakatoa, Lake Victoria, Cerro de Potosí and more.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The world gets more places worth exploring, settling, and fighting over — classic content depth.

Compatibility: Content mod; the wonders integrate with the base ruleset. Pairs well with Prettier Lakes.

Rosetta — Dynamic City Names

by SeelingCat

What it does: Cities change their names to match their owner's culture, and duplicate names never appear in the same game — a conquered York becomes Eboracum again.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The map tells a story of conquest and culture; fully modular across mods and DLC.

Compatibility: Flavor mod; works regardless of enabled DLC.

Sukritact's Resources

by sukritact

What it does: Adds new resources across the board: Cheese, Camels, Obsidian, Gold (mine), Bison, and more, each with sensible yields on their improvement.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Richer economies — more luxuries and bonuses to trade, improve, and fight over.

Compatibility: Content mod, balanced yields; also serves as a base for other mods.

Sukritact's Oceans

by sukritact

What it does: A brand new game mode: kelp forests teem the coasts, new ocean resources (seals, squid, coral) appear, and the seas gain real gameplay.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Oceans stop being a blue void — the map's coasts become a strategic layer of their own.

Compatibility: Game mode toggled in Advanced Setup. May not be fully compatible with the Yet (not) Another Maps Pack — pick per game (details in Chapter 3).

Wetlands

by JNR

What it does: Adds real gameplay around wetlands: new tiles, yields, and decisions for the world's most productive — and most neglected — terrain.

Why it's in the Chronicle: Marshes become a strategic choice instead of filler terrain.

Compatibility: Requires Gathering Storm. Incompatible with mods that let you harvest all resources.

Yet (not) Another Maps Pack

by Gedemon

What it does: The classic map pack: dozens of real and fantasy maps including True Start Earth, with realistic continents and start positions.

Why it's in the Chronicle: The grand-chronicle way to play — the actual Earth, with real starting locations.

Compatibility: Maps only. _Keep map size at Enormous or smaller_ — sizes above Enormous crash late-game on the Gathering Storm build. If you want Sukritact's Oceans in the same game, prefer standard map scripts over YnAMP maps.

2.5 Deliberately not in this list

- *CQUI / HBUI* — monolithic UI overhauls that bundle several of the mods above; they are stale relative to the final build and superseded by the individual, maintained mods.
- *Better Balanced Game (BBG)* — a competitive multiplayer rebalance; it re-tunes the whole economy and conflicts with the 'deepen, don't rebalance' goal, and it must not sit next to Real Strategy.
- *AI+ / RHAI* — fine mods on their own, but AI overhauls do not stack; Real Strategy is the single choice here.

- *Heroes & Legends, Zombie Defense, Apocalypse* game modes — gimmicks and power spikes that make the game easier or weirder.
- Anything that hands the player free yields, cheaper units, or faster tech — that is the opposite of this list's charter.

3 How to Play

This chapter assumes you know the shape of a 4X game but want to play *Civ VI* **well** with *The Grand Chronicle* installed — what to set up, which game modes earn their place, and how to read the game with the mods' new lenses, era by era.

3.1 Creating your game: the Chronicle baseline

From the main menu choose **Single Player** → **Create Game** and open **Advanced Setup**. This baseline works for every persona in Chapter 4:

Setting	Chronicle baseline
Map type	Continents (or Pangaea for a bloodier game; Fractal for variety; YnAMP True Start Earth for the Chronicler persona)
Map size	Standard (Large is fine on strong PCs; YnAMP: never above Enormous)
Game speed	Standard (Epic for the Chronicler persona — eras last longer, the world gets to breathe)
Difficulty	King to start; Emperor once the AI mod feels comfortable; Prince for pure sandbox
Disaster intensity	2 (moderate climate events; 4 if you want Gathering Storm to bite)
Start position	Legendary (fair starts; the game is hard enough without rerolling)
World age	New (more hills — pairs beautifully with Hillier Hills)
Resources	Standard (Abundant if you want a friendlier economy , not an easier game)
Rainfall	Standard (Wet gives Wetlands terrain more presence)

Tip

The **number of civilizations** is worth tuning: 8 civs on Standard keeps the map competitive without crowding. The mods don't change how many civs fit a map.

3.1.1 Game modes: which earn their place

Game modes are official DLC toggles in Advanced Setup — choose them per game, not per install.

Mode	Verdict	Why
Monopolies & Corporations	<i>Recommended</i>	Economic depth: monopolies, corporations, products, and a tourism hook. The single best 'deepen the economy' mode — the Merchant Republic persona is built on it.
Barbarian Clans	Recommended	Barbarian camps become evolving clans that can be hired or recruited into city-states — more texture, not more power.
Dramatic Ages	Optional	Ages swing hard, cities can flip, dark ages bite. Deeper and harder — for the Chronicler and veterans.

Secret Societies	Optional	Four fantasy societies with strong bonuses. Honest note: this is the most power-giving mode, so it sits on the optional shelf, not the default.
Heroes & Legends	Leave off	Heroes are flat power spikes — the exact thing this list avoids.
Apocalypse / Zombie Defense	Leave off	Gimmick modes; they skew the world toward spectacle rather than strategy.
Sukritact's Oceans	Per game	A mod game mode (Chapter 2). Great on standard map scripts; skip it on YnAMP maps.

3.2 Reading the game with The Grand Chronicle

The UI mods are not decoration — they change **how you make decisions**:

- *Quick Deals* turns diplomacy into a market. Sell luxuries and strategics the moment they are spare; check every leader's offer before spending a trade turn.
- *Detailed Map Tacks* makes districts a planning puzzle. Before you settle, tack out the campus/holy site/government plaza chain you want; the tacks show the adjacency math before you commit tiles.
- *Extended Policy Cards* removes the “card amnesia”: swap policies when the numbers say so, not from memory. Revisit after every new district or war declaration.
- *Extended Diplomacy Ribbon* + *Global Relations Panel* give you the diplomatic map: who is weak, who is friendly, who everyone hates. Use it — grievances and alliances are visible strategy.
- *Better Combat Preview* changes war: you see damage ranges before you attack. Ambushes and favorable terrain become things you **engineer**, not hope for.
- *Better Report Screen* is your endgame dashboard: units, deals, policies, minors — one screen to plan your victory push.
- *Real Strategy* makes the AI behave like a player with a plan. Respect it: the AI now builds districts that make sense, which means it **will** have an economy by the Renaissance. Early aggression windows are real, but so are its counterattacks.

3.3 Era by era

3.3.1 Ancient Era — the first forty turns

- *Open* with a scout (or two) and a slinger: meet city-states for free first-meet envoys, find your neighbors, and grab the tribal villages.
- *Settle on fresh water* (river or coast) and **plan before you plant**: your first three cities should have room to grow into their districts. Drop tacks now, settle accordingly.
- *Tech eureka culture*: don't research blind — read what boosts a tech (build that pasture, meet that civ) and let the boosts pull you forward. This is the game's hidden skill floor.
- *Combat*: slingers with the warrior are enough to clear camps. Do not over-build military in a peaceful opening — every unit is a missed settler.

3.3.2 Classical & Medieval — governments and golden ages

- *Era score is a resource* (Rise & Fall / Gathering Storm). Aim for a Golden Age in the Classical era — the Legacy bonuses compound for the rest of the game.
- *Governors* (R&F/GS): Magnus (settler/chopping economy), Pingala (science/culture), Liang (builder safety). Move them deliberately; their promotions are long-term investments.
- *Policy economy*: with Extended Policy Cards, you can **see** when a military card beats a growth card. Re-swap every few turns — that's the actual government minigame.
- *Loyalty* (R&F/GS): don't settle inside your neighbor's pressure bubble unless you plan to take their cities next. Foreign cities flip; yours can too.
- *Wonders*: pick two or three per era that match your victory (Chapter 4 personas say which). With Real Strategy installed, the AI races you — check the wonder screen and pivot when beaten.

3.3.3 Renaissance & Industrial — the economy era

- *Trade routes are your second economy* (Gathering Storm makes them even more vital). With Better Trade Screen, sort by gold/science and keep every route filled — internal routes grow new cities, external routes make money and spread religion.
- *Corporations* (if Monopolies & Corporations is on): monopolies come from controlling a luxury's sources — trade for them, don't gift them. Products are endgame gold.
- *Great People*: with Real Great People, the window shows portraits and points. Plan **which** great person you want and protect your lead in that category — don't let a neighbor's Theatre Square out-accumulate you.
- *Alliances*: a Research or Economic Alliance with the right neighbor is compounding value. The Global Relations Panel shows who's actually reliable.

3.3.4 Modern & Atomic — the war era

- *War is a calculation now*: use Better Combat Preview to confirm fights before committing. Corps and armies (GS) double your punch — but oil gates the good stuff.
- *Power* (GS): plan power districts (Industrial Zones, Dams, power plants) before you need them; running out mid-war is a classic collapse.
- *Spies*: a handful of spies doing missions (steal great works, siphon gold, disrupt rocketry) is more value than any wonder this era. Assign them like governors.
- *Diplomacy under pressure*: the ribbon shows who's arming up. If a neighbor's strength is spiking, that's your war warning — bribe their target, or be the target.

3.3.5 Information & Future — the victory era

- *Pick your lane in Chapter 4's roadmap and commit*. Late-game Civ VI punishes dithering more than any other era.
- *Production Queue earns its keep*: queue up space-race projects, districts, and wonder chains so no city idles.
- *Climate* (GS): carbon emissions drive sea-level rise; coastal cities flood. If you're the top polluter, expect the world congress to tax you.
- *The endgame dash*: science → Mars; culture → rock bands and tourism; diplomacy → world congress votes; domination → the last capitals. Watch all four progress meters in the victory screen — the AI is pushing its own lane.

3.4 Empire systems, quickly

- *Districts*: adjacency is king — campus/holy site adjacency from mountains and reefs, government plaza chains, aqueduct/dam combos for industrial zones. Tacks make this visible.
- *Housing & amenities*: grow to the housing cap, then build neighborhoods (later) — amenities above all prevent production loss and riots (late game: Entertainment Complexes, luxuries, policies).
- *Loyalty*: pressure from nearby cities and civics; governors, garrisons, and population decide who keeps the city.
- *Grievances* (GS): declare war without cause and the world hates you; casus belli keeps grievances low. The ribbon shows the fallout.
- *Religion*: founding a religion is optional but powerful (faith economy, relics, city-state Suzerain bonuses, religious victory). If you skip it, at least defend against it.
- *City-states*: first meet = free envoy; 3 envoys = Suzerain. Suzerain bonuses are among the strongest incentives in the game — the report screen's new minors tab tracks them.
- *Tourism* (culture victory): great works, wonders, relics, seaside resorts, rock bands. Theming bonuses (same era/type in one museum) multiply tourism — Great Works Viewer exists for this.
- *Climate* (GS): CO₂ from coal/oil plants, floods and droughts scale with disaster intensity. Clean energy later; the congress votes on carbon taxes.

3.5 Victory roadmaps

- *Science*: campuses everywhere → universities → Oxford/space agency wonders → moon/mars projects. Pingala in the spaceport city, Production Queue on the projects, research alliances. **Persona: The Cradle of Science.**

- *Culture*: theatre squares, wonders, artifacts, then rock bands; monopolies multiply tourism if that mode is on. **Persona: The Architect of Wonders.**
- *Domination*: an early war to cripple a neighbor, then snowball — but Real Strategy's AI will punish a stalled war. Corps, oil, and air power close it out. **Persona: The Iron Chancellor.**
- *Diplomatic*: win world congress votes — build Statue of Liberty, spread your government's appeal, bank favour with everyone. **Persona: The Merchant Republic.**
- *Religious*: found early, spread hard, defend apostles — theological combat is real combat. **Persona: The Faithful Pilgrim.**
- *Score*: the patient person's victory — outlast everyone with the best empire. **Persona: The Chronicler of Eras.**

Good to know

One game, one persona. Chapter 4 turns these roadmaps into characters — with the exact creation choices each one needs.

4 Personas

Who are you in this chronicle? Six ways to play the same modded world — each with a background, and the game-creation choices that make it yours.

4.1 Before you start: how “creation” works here

Civ 6 has no character creator — your identity comes from the choices in **Advanced Setup** and the rules you keep:

- *The civilization and leader*. This is your kit: unique district, unique units, leader ability. Each persona pairs them with a victory lane.
- *The map and the world*. Map type, size, speed, and game modes shape **how** the story plays out — an archipelago is a different chronicle than a Pangaea.
- *The difficulty and the house rules*. Difficulty sets the opponent's economy; house rules are the real character: what you may do, what you must do, what counts as winning.
- *The mods*. Chapter 2's list is one installation; each persona simply leans on the mods that matter to its playstyle and picks its game modes accordingly.
- *The save*. Name each game after its persona (grand-architect, grand-chancellor, ...) and keep one active game per persona — switching personas means starting a new chronicle, not a new install.

Good to know

All six personas run on the same modlist — the personas differ in civ, setup, and self-imposed rules, not in mods. Keep one save per persona so you can always return to an old chronicle.

4.2 1 • The Architect of Wonders

The Architect of Wonders *Difficulty: King · Focus: culture, wonders, and a skyline that tells your story*

Background. You do not conquer the world; you **beautify** it. The Architect measures an empire in wonders per era, themed museums, and cities worth photographing. You pick wonder timings like a craftsman, plan districts like a city planner, and let the culture victory come as the natural by-product of building something worth remembering. Your empire should look as good on the map as it does on the victory screen.

Game creation choices

- **Civ & leader:** China led by Qin Shi Huang — the wonder-building, worker-driven kit that rewards exactly your obsession. (Egypt's Cleopatra is the riverside alternative.)

- **Map:** Continents, Standard size, Standard speed, World age New (hills for the views).
- **Game modes:** Monopolies & Corporations on (monopolies multiply tourism); everything else default.
- **House rules:** at least two wonders completed every era; builders must be **earned** — no buying them with gold before the Medieval era; never chop a wonder's production (real architects don't demolish forests for columns).
- **Goal:** three wonders per era, one fully themed museum, and a culture victory — or simply the most beautiful empire at the score screen.
- **Mods that shine:** Detailed Map Tacks (wonder adjacency planning), Extended Policy Cards, Terra Mirabilis (20 new natural wonders to build around), Colorized Historic Moments, City Sprawl Graphics, Prettier Lakes.

4.3 2 • The Iron Chancellor

The Iron Chancellor *Difficulty: King–Emperor • Focus: domination through economy, not zerg*

Background. You are a statesman first and a general second: the Iron Chancellor builds an industrial heartland, then wages **surgical** wars — declared with cause, fought with corps, and closed with negotiated peace that extracts a price. You denounce, you demand, you calculate. With Real Strategy installed, the AI fights like a rival great power, which is exactly the opponent you want.

Game creation choices

- **Civ & leader:** Germany led by Frederick Barbarossa — extra district per city, the Hansa industrial district, and military city-state affinity.
- **Map:** Pangaea, Standard size, Standard speed (fighting on one continent; an Archipelago run is the veteran's remix).
- **Game modes:** default modes off; Barbarian Clans on (more factions, more politics).
- **House rules:** no war before the Medieval era (chancellors prepare first); every war needs a **casus belli** — denounce first, then demand; never accept peace without a city, a luxury, or a tribute in gold; maintain a standing army of at least six units at all times.
- **Goal:** annex two rivals' capitals, then win by domination — or by score if the world sues for peace first.
- **Mods that shine:** Better Combat Preview (calculate every assault), Extended Diplomacy Ribbon (read the balance of power), Real Strategy (the AI pushes back), Production Queue (keep the war machine fed).

4.4 3 • The Cradle of Science

The Cradle of Science *Difficulty: Emperor • Focus: science victory, no shortcuts*

Background. You are a research institute with a flag. Every campus is a cathedral, every eureka a doctrine, and the space race is the only race you recognize. You out-tech your neighbors until the game is decided in your favor — not because the game was easy, but because you read it better. The Cradle plays clean: no gold-purchased progress, no exploited cheese — just the long compounding arc of a knowledge economy.

Game creation choices

- **Civ & leader:** Korea led by Seondeok — a campus-adjacency kit built for exactly this lane. (Scotland is the alternative for the happiness/tech angle.)
- **Map:** Continents, Standard size, Standard speed.
- **Game modes:** default modes off — a clean ruleset is the point.
- **House rules:** every city must contain a campus (settle accordingly); gold may **never** buy buildings or projects — everything must be produced or built; no reloading, ever; at least one research alliance maintained from the Medieval era on.
- **Goal:** science victory; the personal target is being first to the Information era tech tree's crown.
- **Mods that shine:** Detailed Map Tacks (campus adjacency), Better Report Screen (the empire-wide dashboard), Production Queue (space projects without idle cities), Sukritact's Simple UI Adjustments.

4.5 4 • The Merchant Republic

The Merchant Republic *Difficulty: King · Focus: trade, gold, and winning the world congress*

Background. You were born with a ledger in hand. The Merchant Republic wins by being **indispensable**: every neighbor trades with you, every city-state Suzerain owes you a favour, and the world congress eventually votes for the republic that bankrolls the world. You measure your empire in trade routes at capacity, gold in the treasury, and diplomatic favour in the bank. When war comes — and it will — you buy the peace.

Game creation choices

- **Civ & leader:** Portugal led by João III — the trade-route economy, built for foreign ports and gold. (Netherlands is the riverside alternative.)
- **Map:** Archipelago, Standard size, Standard speed — a maritime world where routes and ports matter.
- **Game modes:** Monopolies & Corporations *on* (the mode this persona is built for); Secret Societies optional if you want a splash of fantasy.
- **House rules:** trade routes must run at capacity from the moment they unlock; gold must be reinvested within five turns (build, buy, or gift — no hoarding); every city-state you meet gets at least one envoy.
- **Goal:** diplomatic victory — or 100,000 gold in the treasury, whichever comes first.
- **Mods that shine:** Quick Deals (the market at a keystroke), Better Trade Screen (route yield sorting), Global Relations Panel (who owes whom), Sukritact's Resources (more luxuries to monopolize and trade).

4.6 5 • The Faithful Pilgrim

The Faithful Pilgrim *Difficulty: King · Focus: religion, faith economy, and the slow conversion*

Background. You do not rush. The Pilgrim's faith spreads like a tide: founded early, defended patiently, and carried on trade routes and missionary trails to every corner of the map. Yours is the quiet victory — no armies, no rockets, just the quiet compounding of belief until the world converts around you. The modded game rewards this patience: a faith economy funds districts, buildings, and even the late-game culture push.

Game creation choices

- **Civ & leader:** Russia led by Peter the Great — the faith-and-culture-from-tundra kit with the Lavra district. (Byzantium is the aggressive alternative.)
- **Map:** Continents, Standard size, Standard speed.
- **Game modes:** default modes off.
- **House rules:** found a religion by turn 100 or restart the chronicle; every Holy Site must be **built**, never bought; convert at least one city in every other civilization — including rivals you never meet peacefully (trade routes and apostles do the job).
- **Goal:** religious victory, converted cleanly — and a faith stockpile to fund the endgame as a bonus.
- **Mods that shine:** More Lenses (holy-site adjacency), Extended Policy Cards (faith policies), Real Great People (the overview that plans your prophet and apostles), Better Report Screen.

4.7 6 • The Chronicler of Eras

The Chronicler of Eras *Difficulty: Prince · Focus: the living world — no victory hunting*

Background. You play the long game that isn't a game: the Chronicler builds a **world** and lets history happen to it. Wars, golden ages, floods, and revolutions all belong in the record. You name your cities in the tongue of the era (Rosetta does the renaming), pause at era transitions to admire the map, and let Dramatic Ages toss your empire up and down. Victory is optional — the chronicle is the point. Screenshots welcome.

Game creation choices

- **Civ & leader:** your pick — Rome led by Trajan is the classic empire-building arc; Japan or Egypt change the flavor of the chronicle.
- **Map:** YnAMP *True Start Earth* (or Continents), up to Enormous size, *Epic* speed — the world gets time to breathe.
- **Game modes:** Barbarian Clans and Dramatic Ages *on* (history should bite); Sukritact's Oceans on if you use a standard map script instead of YnAMP.
- **House rules:** never chase a victory type — pursue whatever the era demands (era score decides); never restart a save, never reload a disaster; screenshot every era transition; write the story in your head as you go.
- **Goal:** a world history you would retell — and the highest era score you can honestly earn.
- **Mods that shine:** the whole World & Content stack — YnAMP, Rosetta, Terra Mirabilis, Wetlands, Sukritact's Resources (+ Oceans), Environment Skin, Denser Vegetation, City Sprawl Graphics, Colorized Historic Moments, Hillier Hills, Prettier Lakes.

4.8 How to start a persona run

1. Create a game in **Advanced Setup** with the persona's settings from above.
2. Name the save grand-<persona> so the chronicles stay separate.
3. Write your house rules on paper — three lines of rules beat a forgotten promise in turn 200.
4. Enable the persona's game modes and play the first era following its priorities.

<i>Persona</i>	<i>Difficulty</i>	<i>Signature mods</i>
The Architect of Wonders	King	Detailed Map Tacks, Terra Mirabilis, Colorized Historic Moments, City Sprawl Graphics
The Iron Chancellor	King–Emperor	Better Combat Preview, Extended Diplomacy Ribbon, Real Strategy, Production Queue
The Cradle of Science	Emperor	Detailed Map Tacks, Better Report Screen, Production Queue, Simple UI Adjustments
The Merchant Republic	King	Quick Deals, Better Trade Screen, Global Relations Panel, Sukritact's Resources
The Faithful Pilgrim	King	More Lenses, Extended Policy Cards, Real Great People, Better Report Screen
The Chronicler of Eras	Prince	YnAMP, Rosetta, Terra Mirabilis, Wetlands, Environment Skin, Denser Vegetation, Colorized Historic Moments